

Russian tanker heads to Cuba despite U.S. oil blockade

It would be the first shipment of oil to the island since January, bringing some temporary relief to a country of 9.6 million people that has endured a deepening energy and economic crisis

Updated – March 30, 2026 07:46 am IST – Havana

AFP



Image used for representative purpose only. | Photo Credit: Reuters

A Russian oil tanker under U.S. sanctions is due to arrive in Cuba by Tuesday (March 31, 2026) despite a de facto American fuel blockade of the energy-starved island, according to shipping data.

The Anatoly Kolodkin, which is carrying 730,000 barrels of crude, was off the eastern tip of Cuba on Sunday (March 29), according to shipping tracker MarineTraffic.

